



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Iran (Islamic Republic of). I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.
What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing your background — you're in an important phase right now where the choices you make can shape a lot of your future opportunities. Since you've just finished primary school (which in Denmark typically means *folkeskolen*, around 9th or 10th grade), you now have several options. I'll walk you through the most common paths and offer some recommendations based on your situation.

1. Gymnasiale Uddannelser (General Upper Secondary Education)

These are the academically-focused programs that prepare you for higher education, like university.

- **STX (Studentereksamen)** – Broad and academic. Good if you're not sure yet but are interested in a mix of humanities, science, and languages.
- **HHX (Higher Commercial Examination)** – Focuses on business, economics, and international trade. Great if you're into business or entrepreneurship.
- **HTX (Higher Technical Examination)** – Focus on technology, natural sciences, and engineering. Ideal if you like science, computers, or innovation.
- **HF (Higher Preparatory Examination)** – Shorter (2 years), often more practical. Can be good if you want to get into higher education but prefer a less intense academic setting.

 **Recommended if:** You want to keep many doors open, and might consider university later.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training, EUD)

These are job-focused and combine school and apprenticeships (*praktik*). After 1–2 years, you can begin working or build further with *EUX* (a combination of vocational training and academic studies).

Examples:

- Electrician, carpenter, chef, mechanic, dental assistant, social and healthcare helper (*SOSU*).

 **Recommended if:** You prefer hands-on work and want to start a career sooner, or earn while you learn.

3. EUX – Both Vocational and Academic

This is a mix: you learn a skilled trade and also get the academic foundation to go to university later if you want.

 **Recommended if:** You're practical but also want the option of studying further.

 **Given your background (Danish-born, Iranian parents, fluent in Danish), you might also consider:**

- Using your multicultural background and language skills: professions like **international business, diplomacy, translation, immigration law, or teaching** could be a good fit.
- Helping your community: some students with a migrant background find it meaningful to work in **social work, healthcare, or education**, helping others integrate.

My Personal Recommendation (Based on Your Age and Options)

Since you're only 16 and just finished *folkeskolen*, **I recommend choosing a gymnasial education (like STX, HHX, or HTX)** unless you already have a clear passion for a trade or career.

Here's how you can choose:

Interest	Recommended Path
Business, marketing, law	HHX
Science, technology, IT	HTX
Humanities, languages, society	STX
Want to work soon, love hands-on tasks	EUD / EUX

Final Advice

- **Visit the schools:** Most offer *åbent hus* (open house) events where you can talk to students and teachers.
- **Talk to your UU-vejleder** (youth guidance counselor): They can give personal advice.
- **Keep your options open** if you're unsure — it's okay to change paths later.

Would you like help choosing between STX, HHX, or HTX based on your personal interests? Or do you already have a dream career or field in mind?